



Twitter DM's leak

Twitter confirms the recent bug may have exposed some users direct messages to third party developers.
<https://dgit.in/oct18-66-1>



Wireless Charging for Pixel

Google may launch its own wireless charger which docks the phones in portrait mode.
<https://dgit.in/oct18-66-2>

Boo smartwatches

Boo-man isn't fond of 'smart'watches and he's not shy about it.

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I get that most people are lazy. I too, am in the same boat. If I can pay someone to live my life just so that I can sit and game for a few more hours, I'd do it. So in a way I understand how smartwatches enable slow pokes like myself but how about we stop calling them 'smart'watches? A smartwatch is practically a secondary touchscreen for your smartphone. That you slap on your wrist, just so that you don't have to bother with digging into your pocket to get your phone.

In my exalted opinion, a good wristwatch should do two things. One, it should tell the time, and possibly the date. Two, it should be a while before I need to throw in a new battery. Two simple functions, that's all I ask for and it honestly, isn't that much. People might appreciate other complications, but I'm not a fan, unless there is a use case for it. Good wrist watches last for generations. With 'smart'watches you can't tell what the next update is going to do. For all you know, it might just conk off, slow down or get messed up.

A smartwatch is just too much of a hassle at this point to be even a half decent wristwatch. It just does not make sense having to constantly charge your watch, as if charging the mobile phone was not enough of a headache already. Even a cheap quartz watch runs for months on a tiny battery. A hand wound mechanical watch, or even an automatic, does not need an external power source

at all. Now that, is good engineering and craftsmanship.

Smartwatches are just bulky eyeso- res. Worse still, as they get increasingly smart, there emerge more ways to hack them. Even simple carelessness can become a dangerous security threat. Automatic GPS data syncing from smartwatches once led to the discovery of a secret military base. Now every payment gateway service is talking about how smartwatches are going to make transactions easier. If you're talking about making it easier for hackers to take your money, then duh!



Ding, ding, ding! It's time to ... get an actual watch.

Finally, there is the value for money aspect. Smartwatches get outdated really fast, but a good mechanical wristwatch is practically timeless. I just don't see how it makes sense to invest in a timekeeping device that will have a much better version released in the next year. True, by the same logic, there is simply no good computing device one can buy. However, there are no alternatives to smartphones or desktops available in the market. When it comes to wristwatches though, there are very sensible alternatives to smartwatches - the mechanical wristwatches.

Now you might want to point out the fitness benefits of the smartwatch. Let's be realistic about this, it is not really helping anyone. If you are serious about fitness, there are dedicated devices for that which provide more value by sticking to what they do best. If you are monitoring your fitness at that level, a smartwatch just will not cut it in terms of accuracy. To start with, the best trackers and coaching apps require you to have a fitness tracking band on each hand. The data gathered by a pair of fitness trackers is more granular, and thus can be pro-

cessed in more useful ways. Accuracy aside, you'd look like a weirdo walking around with a smartwatch on both your wrists.

I have a deep appreciation for mechanical devices. For most of human history, computing devices and automations ran on clockwork. The mechanical wristwatch has a recorded heritage going all the way back to the mysterious Antikythera mechanism.

It is unfair to consider clockwork as ancient technology. Even NASA is considering sending a mechanical rover to Venus, which has an environment that would pulverise any delicate electronics. Smart device - O, mechanical device - 1.

Call me old-fashioned, but if I wear a watch on my wrist, then it better have gears in it. You do not need to rob a bank to buy a decent wristwatch. Take my watch as an example, it's a Seiko 5, a budget friendly automatic. Or if that's a bit too much then the good old hand wound HMTs still work perfectly fine. 